

UIUC CS 374: Introduction to Algorithms and Models of Computation

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1 Lecture 01 - Introduction to CS 374

Important Terms

1.1 Alphabets

Let Σ be an **alphabet**, an arbitrary **finite** set of **symbols** or **characters**

Examples include:

- $\Sigma = \{A, B, \dots, Z\}$
- $\Sigma = \{0, 1\}$

1.2 Strings

A **string** or **word** is a **finite** sequence of symbols from an alphabet

Formally speaking, w is a string over Σ if it is one of

- the **empty string**
- an ordered pair (a, x) , where $a \in \Sigma$ and x is a string over Σ

1.2.1 Example

$$\begin{aligned} \text{STRING} &= (S, (\text{TRING})) \\ &= (S, (T, (\text{RING}))) \\ &= \dots \\ &= (S, (T, (R, (I, (N, (G, \varepsilon))))) \end{aligned}$$

1.3 Functions

Functions are defined recursively, where length $|w|$ represents the number of symbols in w

$$|w| := \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if } w = \varepsilon \\ 1 + |x| & \text{if } w = ax \end{cases}$$

1.3.1 Example

$$\begin{aligned} |HAT| &= 1 + |AT| \\ &= 1 + (1 + |T|) \\ &= 1 + (1 + (1 + |\varepsilon|)) \\ &= \boxed{3} \end{aligned}$$

1.4 Concatenation

Let **concatenation**, $w \bullet z$, of strings w and z be represented as

$$w \bullet z := \begin{cases} z & \text{if } w = \varepsilon \\ (a, x \bullet z) & \text{if } w = ax \end{cases}$$

1.4.1 Example

$$\begin{aligned}
 NOW \bullet HERE &= N \cdot (OW \bullet HERE) \\
 &= N \cdot (O \cdot (W \bullet HERE)) \\
 &= N \cdot (O \cdot (W \cdot (\varepsilon \bullet HERE))) \\
 &= N \cdot (O \cdot (W \cdot HERE)) \\
 &= NOWHERE
 \end{aligned}$$

1.5 Induction

- Consider an arbitrary object (probably of size n)
- **Explicitly** state a **strong** inductive hypothesis (i.e. for all $k < n$)
- Explicitly handle each case for the object
- Use inductive hypothesis when its useful
- End by pointing out you handled all cases

1.5.1 Example 1

For every string, w

$$w \bullet \varepsilon = w$$

Let w be an arbitrary string. Assume for all string x , $|x| < |w|$, such that $x \bullet \varepsilon = x$

Suppose $w = \varepsilon$. Then,

$$\begin{array}{ll}
 w \bullet \varepsilon = \varepsilon \bullet \varepsilon & \text{since } w = \varepsilon \\
 = \varepsilon & \text{by definition of concatenation } (\bullet) \\
 = w & \text{since } w = \varepsilon
 \end{array}$$

1.5.2 Example 2

Suppose $w = a \bullet x$ for symbol a and string x . Prove that in all cases, $w \bullet \varepsilon = w$

$$\begin{array}{ll}
 w \bullet \varepsilon = (a \cdot x) \bullet \varepsilon & (w = ax) \\
 = a \cdot (x \bullet \varepsilon) & \text{(by definition of } \bullet \text{)} \\
 = a \cdot x & \text{(inductive hypothesis)} \\
 = w & (w = ax)
 \end{array}$$

Therefore, in all cases, $w \bullet \varepsilon = w$

1.5.3 Example 3

Let w and z be arbitrary, upon the assumption that for every string x such that $|x| < |w|$, that $|x \bullet z| = |x| + |z|$

1. Suppose that $w = \varepsilon$

Then,

$ w \bullet z = \varepsilon \bullet z $	$w = \varepsilon$
$= z $	by definition of concatenation $\bullet$
$= 0 + z $	arithmetic
$= \varepsilon + z $	by definition of length of string
$= w + z $	$w = \varepsilon$

2. Suppose that $w = a \cdot x$ for some symbol a and string x .

Then,

$ w \bullet z = (a \cdot x) \bullet z $	$w = a \cdot x$
$= a \cdot (x \bullet z) $	by definition of concatenation $\bullet$
$= 1 + x \bullet z $	inductive hypothesis
$= 1 + x + z $	by definition of length of string
$= w + z $	$w = a \cdot x$